PROS FOR SCHEMA TESTING

- Easy to set up
- Integrates with other tools such as OpenAPI Spec V3
- No dependency on environments

PROS FOR CONTRACT TESTING

- Helps visualize how consumers are using the service
- Generates contracts alongside application code
- Allows evolution of time

CONS FOR SCHEMA TESTING

- HTTP details such as status codes and methods aren't defined in a set way with schemas.
- Specific requirements of a consumer can't be tracked with a schema, for example, one consumer uses all the fields within the response, whereas another consumer only uses a subset. However, the whole schema is often used by consumers as the object is converted in code.

CONS FOR CONTRACT TESTING

- Multiple steps are required to determine whether code change can be deployed, and multiple CI pipelines need to sync in order to determine the result.
- Infrastructure required to run contract testing end-to-end includes setting up broker and language-specific implementations, for example, PactNet middleware for state setup.

A.3 Pact Broker hosting options

Table A.1 lists the pros (denoted by +) and cons (denoted by –) of Pact Broker options.